

TOPIC 13 | RELIGION, PHILOSOPHY AND CULTURAL SYNTHESIS

IDEAS BECOME FORMS THROUGH LANGUAGE, INSTITUTION, RITUAL, IMAGE, MONUMENT AND PUBLIC PRACTICE.

CORE RULE: NAME THE MECHANISM, THEN NAME THE LIMIT. DO NOT REPLACE DIFFERENCE WITH A HARMONY SLOGAN.

1. Framework and chronology

- Religion / philosophy here means visible cultural consequences: language, institution, monument, ritual and performance.
- Vedic -> Upanishadic inquiry -> shramana plurality -> darshana map -> Bhakti and Sufi publics.
- Doctrinal proof stays elsewhere; Topic 13 asks how ideas become forms.

2. Darshanas and Vedanta

- Purushartha = artha, dharma, kama, moksha.
- Six orthodox schools = Samkhya, Yoga, Nyaya, Vaisheshika, Mimamsa, Vedanta.
- Shankara -> Advaita -> nirguna + knowledge.
- Ramanuja -> Vishishtadvaita -> attributes + devotion.
- Madhva -> Dvaita -> Brahma Sampradaya.
- Trap: Pushtimarg belongs to Vallabhacharya.

3. Bhakti, Sikh and Sufi publics

- Bhakti causes = orthodoxy / inclusion / Buddhist-Jain decline / patronage.
- Tamil canon = Nayanars 63 / Alvars 12 / Andal.
- Regional evidence = Kabir, Nanak, Basavanna, Jnaneshwar, Tukaram, Mirabai, Janabai.
- Sufi precision = silsilah / khanqah / dargah / malfuzat / maktubat / tazkira.
- Orders differ: Chishti, Suhrawardi, Qadiri, Naqshbandi.

4. Synthesis test and PYQ route

- Synthesis is strongest in shared practice, shrine publics, song and translation; weakest as merged doctrine.
- Named public evidence = Ajmer, Nizamuddin, Khusrau, Baba Farid, Deepavali, Kumbh.
- Idea -> design decision -> evidence -> qualification.
- 2020 direct Mains = philosophy and monuments; 2022 objective routes withheld.